

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Ideology and End of Ideology - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Ideology and End of Ideology

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 The Dual Meaning and Political Work of Ideology

2 Essential Vocabulary of Ideology Critique

3 The Chapter Spine: Distortion, Mobilisation and Closure

4 Theory, Ideology, Utopia and Open Inquiry

5 From Tracy and Bacon to Marx and Lenin

6 Lukacs, Mannheim, Popper and Arendt

7 The End-of-Ideology Proponents

8 Critics, Technocracy, Comparison and Trap Repair

9 Qualified Thesis and Directive-Specific Architecture

10 Evidence, Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Ideology and End of Ideology - Solved Practice Workbook	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	19
VERIFIED PYQ STATUS	19
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	19

Ideology and End of Ideology - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g4 **PYQ ownership:** No directly owned verified PYQ is assigned to this topic; all questions below are original practice.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Ideology (set of ideas)**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29).
- B. A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36).
- C. A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaubu, PDF p.29).
- D. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology (set of ideas)** with **A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29)**.

- A. Karl Marx
- B. Ideology (set of ideas)
- C. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset
- D. Obscurantism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29)**, with **Ideology (set of ideas)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Ideology (science of ideas)**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36).
- B. A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaubu, PDF p.29).
- C. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31).
- D. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology (science of ideas)** with **A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31)**.

- A. V.I. Lenin
- B. Basic orientation
- C. Sociology of knowledge
- D. Ideology (science of ideas)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31)** with **Ideology (science of ideas)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Obscurantism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaubu, PDF p.29).
- B. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaubu, PDF p.35).
- C. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaubu, PDF pp.35-36).
- D. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaubu, PDF p.33).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Obscurantism** with **A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaubu, PDF p.29)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaub, PDF p.29).**

- A. Karl Mannheim
- B. Obscurantism
- C. Temper of mind
- D. Critical theory

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaub, PDF p.29).** with **Obscurantism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Sociology of knowledge**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30).
- B. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics.
- C. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).
- D. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sociology of knowledge** with **Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).**

- A. Karl Popper
- B. Ideology (set of ideas)
- C. Utopia
- D. Sociology of knowledge

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).** with **Sociology of knowledge**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Critical theory**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaubu, PDF p.31).
- B. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaubu, PDF pp.28, 30-31).
- C. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31).
- D. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaubu, PDF p.35).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Critical theory** with **A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaubu, PDF p.31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaubu, PDF p.31)**.

- A. Hannah Arendt
- B. Critical theory
- C. Ideology (science of ideas)
- D. Totalitarianism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaubu, PDF p.31)** with **Critical theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Utopia**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaubu, PDF p.32).
- B. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gaubu, PDF p.31).
- C. A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaubu, PDF p.34).
- D. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaubu, PDF p.35).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Utopia** with **A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaubu, PDF p.34)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaub, PDF p.34).**

- A. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset
- B. Obscurantism
- C. Open society
- D. Utopia

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaub, PDF p.34).** with **Utopia**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Totalitarianism**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).
- B. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34).
- C. Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33).
- D. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Totalitarianism** with **A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).**

- A. Basic orientation
- B. Totalitarianism
- C. Sociology of knowledge
- D. Ideology vs theory

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).** with **Totalitarianism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Open society**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33).
- B. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32).
- C. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35).
- D. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Open society** with **A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35)**.

- A. Temper of mind
- B. Critical theory
- C. Set of ideas vs science of ideas
- D. Open society

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35)** with **Open society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Ideology vs theory**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30).
- B. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32).
- C. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31).
- D. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology vs theory** with **Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30).**

- A. Ideology (set of ideas)
- B. Ideology vs theory
- C. Utopia
- D. Closed mind vs open mind

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30).** with **Ideology vs theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Set of ideas vs science of ideas**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaub, PDF p.35).
- B. A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaub, PDF p.34).
- C. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31).
- D. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Set of ideas vs science of ideas** with **The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31).**

- A. Ideology (science of ideas)
- B. Totalitarianism
- C. Ideology vs utopia
- D. Set of ideas vs science of ideas

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31).** with **Set of ideas vs science of ideas**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Closed mind vs open mind**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gauba, PDF p.32).
- B. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gauba, PDF p.31).
- C. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gauba, PDF p.35).
- D. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.30-31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Closed mind vs open mind** with **Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gauba, PDF p.32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gauba, PDF p.32)**.

- A. Obscurantism
- B. Closed mind vs open mind
- C. Open society
- D. Open society vs totalitarian society

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gauba, PDF p.32)** with **Closed mind vs open mind**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Ideology vs utopia**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gauba, PDF p.29).
- B. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gauba, PDF p.35).
- C. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gauba, PDF p.34).
- D. Matter of faith and commitment (Gauba, PDF p.32).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology vs utopia** with **Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gauba, PDF p.34)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34).**

- A. Sociology of knowledge
- B. Ideology vs theory
- C. Historical thesis vs settled fact
- D. Ideology vs utopia

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34).** with **Ideology vs utopia**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Open society vs totalitarian society**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).
- B. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33).
- C. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32).
- D. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Open society vs totalitarian society** with **In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).**

- A. Critical theory
- B. Open society vs totalitarian society
- C. Set of ideas vs science of ideas
- D. Destutt de Tracy

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).** with **Open society vs totalitarian society**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Historical thesis vs settled fact**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaubu, PDF pp.33-34).
- B. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaubu, PDF p.32).
- C. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics.
- D. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaubu, PDF p.31).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Historical thesis vs settled fact** with **"End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **"End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics**.

- A. Utopia
- B. Closed mind vs open mind
- C. Francis Bacon
- D. Historical thesis vs settled fact

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics** with **Historical thesis vs settled fact**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Destutt de Tracy**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31).
- B. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaubu, PDF p.35).
- C. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaubu, PDF pp.28-29).
- D. A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaubu, PDF p.34).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Destutt de Tracy** with **First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gauba, PDF pp.30-31).**

- A. Totalitarianism
- B. Destutt de Tracy
- C. Ideology vs utopia
- D. Karl Marx

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gauba, PDF pp.30-31).** with **Destutt de Tracy**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Francis Bacon**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gauba, PDF p.35).
- B. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.30-31).
- C. Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gauba, PDF p.31).
- D. A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gauba, PDF pp.35-36).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Francis Bacon** with **Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gauba, PDF p.31).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gauba, PDF p.31).**

- A. Open society
- B. Open society vs totalitarian society
- C. V.I. Lenin
- D. Francis Bacon

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Earlier warned that knowledge can be distorted by false impressions or "idols," anticipating later critique of distorted ideas (Gauba, PDF p.31).** with **Francis Bacon**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Karl Marx**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33).
- B. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).
- C. A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaub, PDF p.29).
- D. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Marx** with **Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33)**.

- A. Ideology vs theory
- B. Karl Marx
- C. Historical thesis vs settled fact
- D. Karl Mannheim

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology is false consciousness linked to material conditions and dominant-class rule (Gaub, PDF pp.32-33)** with **Karl Marx**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **V.I. Lenin**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaub, PDF p.32).
- B. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gaub links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaub, PDF p.31).
- C. Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33).
- D. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaub, PDF pp.29-30).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **V.I. Lenin** with **Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33).**

- A. Set of ideas vs science of ideas
- B. Destutt de Tracy
- C. Karl Popper
- D. V.I. Lenin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Proletariat too needs ideology, namely scientific socialism, because class struggle persists in the socialist phase (Gaub, PDF p.33).** with **V.I. Lenin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Karl Mannheim**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaub, PDF pp.33-34).
- B. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaub, PDF p.32).
- C. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaub, PDF p.31).
- D. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaub, PDF pp.28, 30-31).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Mannheim** with **All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaub, PDF pp.33-34).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaub, PDF pp.33-34).**

- A. Closed mind vs open mind
- B. Karl Mannheim
- C. Francis Bacon
- D. Hannah Arendt

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **All thought is socially situated; ideology conserves, utopia agitates, and sociology of knowledge seeks a more objective synthesis (Gaub, PDF pp.33-34).** with **Karl Mannheim**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Karl Popper**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A set of ideas accepted as true by a group, party or nation without further examination, often used to justify or denounce a social or political arrangement (Gaub, PDF pp.28-29).
- B. A fascinating but unrealizable vision or set of principles used by Mannheim to contrast with ideology (Gaub, PDF p.34).
- C. Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaub, PDF p.35).
- D. Gaub's dimensions table opposes ideology-as-faith to science-of-ideas as critical examination and openness to questioning authority (Gaub, PDF p.32).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Popper** with **Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaub, PDF p.35)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaub, PDF p.35)**.

- A. Ideology vs utopia
- B. Karl Marx
- C. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset
- D. Karl Popper

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Ideology belongs to totalitarian societies claiming final truth, not to open societies that permit criticism (Gaub, PDF p.35)** with **Karl Popper**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Hannah Arendt**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).
- B. A study of how ideas are formed, distorted and purified so that true knowledge may be separated from false knowledge (Gaub, PDF pp.30-31).
- C. A regime-form seeking to direct all aspects of life toward state-defined goals and suppress criticism or alternative aims (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).
- D. Mannheim treats both as forms of false consciousness: ideology conserves the status quo, utopia energizes change through unrealizable projection (Gaub, PDF p.34).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hannah Arendt** with **Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).**

- A. Open society vs totalitarian society
- B. Hannah Arendt
- C. V.I. Lenin
- D. Basic orientation

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Totalitarianism is marked by ideology plus terror and depends on specific social and political conditions of mass uprootedness (Gaub, PDF p.35).** with **Hannah Arendt**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A deliberate effort to keep things obscure so that people do not know the truth (Gaub, PDF p.29).
- B. A society with free flow of information, criticism, policy revision and no monopoly claim to truth (Gaub, PDF p.35).
- C. They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).
- D. In Popper's contrast, open society allows criticism and revision; totalitarian society claims final truth and mobilizes resources through ideology (Gaub, PDF pp.35-36).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset** with **They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).**

- A. Historical thesis vs settled fact
- B. Karl Mannheim
- C. Temper of mind
- D. Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **They advance historical end-of-ideology arguments about Western/post-capitalist/post-industrial societies in the 1950s-60s (Gaub, PDF pp.37-39).** with **Daniel Bell / Dahrendorf / Lipset**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Basic orientation**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. Matter of faith and commitment (Gaubu, PDF p.32).
- B. Inquiry into how knowledge is socially determined, conditioned or distorted; Gauba links the term especially with Mannheim (Gaubu, PDF p.31).
- C. Ideology is interested, action-oriented and justificatory; theory is disinterested, critical and validity-testing (Gaubu, PDF pp.29-30).
- D. "End of ideology" is a context-bound thesis about mid-twentieth-century industrial societies, not a permanent law of politics.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Basic orientation** with **Matter of faith and commitment (Gaubu, PDF p.32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Matter of faith and commitment (Gaubu, PDF p.32)**.

- A. Destutt de Tracy
- B. Basic orientation
- C. Karl Popper
- D. Ideology (set of ideas)

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Matter of faith and commitment (Gaubu, PDF p.32)** with **Basic orientation**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option is the exact canonical pairing recorded for **Temper of mind**? Other options belong to different named entries.

- A. A stream of thought that studies society from the angle of deviation from rational human emancipation, not by simply copying natural-science paradigms (Gaubu, PDF p.31).
- B. The first sense mobilizes adherents; the second sense studies how ideas arise and become distorted (Gaubu, PDF pp.28, 30-31).
- C. Closed or partisan certainty (Gaubu, PDF p.32).
- D. First used ideology as the science of ideas and tied valid knowledge to empirical learning (Gaubu, PDF pp.30-31).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Temper of mind** with **Closed or partisan certainty (Gaubu, PDF p.32)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Closed or partisan certainty (Gauba, PDF p.32)**.

- A. Francis Bacon
- B. Hannah Arendt
- C. Ideology (science of ideas)
- D. Temper of mind

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Closed or partisan certainty (Gauba, PDF p.32)** with **Temper of mind**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain the two principal meanings of ideology and distinguish ideology from political theory. Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Explain**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Ideology has a dual meaning: it may denote an organised body of political ideas, and it may denote inquiry into how ideas arise, become distorted and serve social interests.

Core analysis: In the first sense, ideology supplies identity, justification and a programme of action to a group. In the second, beginning with the science-of-ideas tradition and later critique, attention shifts to the social production of consciousness. Political theory differs because it subjects claims to evidence, conceptual clarification and normative criticism instead of merely securing commitment. Ideology asks adherents to mobilise around a view of order; theory asks whether that view is coherent and justified.

Critical evaluation: The distinction must remain qualified. A political theory can acquire an ideological function when its assumptions are insulated from criticism, while an ideology may contain genuine emancipatory insight.

Conclusion: Ideology may describe an organised idea-system or the study of socially distorted thought, but it differs from theory whenever commitment is insulated from critical testing.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Explain the two principal meanings of ideology and distinguish ideology from political theory." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: How does Marx's use of ideology differ from Lenin's use of the term? Answer in about 150 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **How**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: 150 words: one-sentence thesis, three compact claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one qualification and a direct two-line conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Marx and Lenin both connect ideas with class struggle, but they assign a different range and political function to ideology.

Core analysis: For Marx, ideology chiefly expresses false consciousness: ruling ideas present historically contingent relations of domination as natural or universal because they reflect dominant material interests. The concept is therefore mainly diagnostic and pejorative. Lenin broadens the term. Since spontaneous worker consciousness may remain within bourgeois limits, the proletariat also requires a systematic socialist ideology capable of organising emancipatory struggle. Ideology is no longer only the mask of domination; it can also become a weapon of class transformation.

Critical evaluation: Lenin's extension solves the problem of mobilisation but creates a new danger: a party may claim privileged access to correct consciousness and suppress internal criticism.

Conclusion: Marx's pejorative account explains domination through false consciousness, whereas Lenin also treats ideology as a necessary vehicle of emancipatory class consciousness.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "How does Marx's use of ideology differ from Lenin's use of the term?" - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 10 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Examine Mannheim's sociology of knowledge and the difficulty in his proposed solution. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Examine**: define the controlling concept, explain the mechanism in ordered steps, add one material qualification and answer every part of the stem. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Mannheim generalises ideology critique by arguing that thought is socially situated rather than treating distortion as a defect of only the ruling class.

Core analysis: He distinguishes ideology, which tends to conserve an existing order, from utopia, which inspires groups seeking radical change. Both can become partial because social location shapes what appears plausible and important. Sociology of knowledge therefore studies the relation between ideas and their social setting. Mannheim proposes a relatively free-floating intelligentsia capable of synthesising partial perspectives and moving toward a more comprehensive judgment.

Further development: His contribution is strongest when used comparatively: instead of dismissing an opponent as simply irrational, the analyst reconstructs the social horizon that makes a belief persuasive. Yet the genetic fallacy must be avoided. Explaining where a belief came from does not establish whether it is true. The synthesis must therefore remain a hypothesis tested through public criticism.

Critical evaluation: The proposal remains vulnerable. Social origin does not by itself establish the validity or falsity of an idea, and the intelligentsia cannot simply stand outside every social location. Relational understanding must still be

tested through reasons and evidence.

Conclusion: Mannheim powerfully socialises knowledge, but his appeal to a relatively detached intelligentsia does not fully solve the problem of how socially situated judgment can claim validity.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Examine Mannheim's sociology of knowledge and the difficulty in his proposed solution." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Discuss Popper and Arendt on ideological closure and totalitarianism. Answer in about 200 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Discuss**: cover the principal dimensions, connect named evidence to each claim, include the strongest counter-position and conclude directly. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 200 words: thesis, four or five developed claim -> named evidence -> analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified conclusion. **Model solution**

Introduction: Popper and Arendt analyse the point at which ideology ceases to be one contestable political perspective and becomes an instrument of total domination.

Core analysis: Popper defends the open society, where institutions permit criticism, error correction and piecemeal reform. Ideologies claiming final historical truth close inquiry and justify coercion against dissent. Arendt shows how totalitarianism fuses an all-explanatory ideology with terror, organisation and the isolation of uprooted masses. Ideology supplies deductive certainty; terror forces reality to conform to that alleged logic. Both accounts therefore connect political freedom with plurality and the possibility of revising belief.

Further development: Popper's emphasis is institutional and epistemic: fallibility requires criticism and reversible reform. Arendt's emphasis is historical and political: atomisation, terror and total organisation make the ideological fiction socially operative. Their accounts converge on closure but differ in mechanism. This distinction prevents the loose conclusion that every strong political belief is totalitarian.

Critical evaluation: Their target is not every political commitment. Democratic politics cannot be value-free; the danger arises when one doctrine monopolises truth and destroys the institutions of contestation.

Conclusion: Both expose the danger of monopoly truth, but the lasting lesson is not ideology-free politics; it is the institutional protection of criticism, plurality and revisability.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Discuss Popper and Arendt on ideological closure and totalitarianism." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 15 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Critically evaluate the end-of-ideology thesis and the objections raised against it. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Critically evaluate**: reconstruct the position accurately, test its strongest objection and reply, then give a graded verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: The end-of-ideology thesis claimed that the great doctrinal conflicts of industrial society had lost force in affluent Western democracies.

Core analysis: Bell, Dahrendorf and Lipset associated this change with welfare-state compromise, mixed economy, pluralism and the institutional containment of industrial conflict. Rostow offered a developmental language that appeared to transcend ideological systems, while Galbraith emphasised managerial and technical decision-making. Critics such as Titmuss, Wright Mills, Macpherson and MacIntyre replied that the thesis converted one historically specific liberal settlement into a universal endpoint. By treating prevailing institutions as neutral, it concealed continuing inequalities and defended the status quo.

Further development: The thesis also confuses reduced doctrinal polarisation with the disappearance of ideology. Welfare compromise can narrow conflict while leaving disputes over ownership, participation and global inequality unresolved. Galbraith's technostructure strengthens the critics' case because managerial power may operate without mass ideological rhetoric. The thesis should therefore be treated as a historically bounded diagnosis of affluent Western societies, not a universal law. Its continued value lies in prompting inquiry into where ideology migrates when political language becomes managerial. Recurrent conflict over distribution further weakens any final-end claim.

Critical evaluation: The thesis identifies a real period of convergence but overstates its permanence. Managerial language can relocate ideology into apparently technical choices rather than abolish it.

Conclusion: The thesis captured a limited period of Western convergence, yet its own status-quo assumptions confirm that ideological conflict was displaced rather than ended.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Critically evaluate the end-of-ideology thesis and the objections raised against it." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Is technocratic managerialism ideologically neutral? Discuss with reference to the end-of-ideology debate. Answer in about 250 words.

Demand decoding: The operative directive is **Is**: answer the proposition immediately, specify the conditions or degree, test the counter-position and return to a qualified yes/no verdict. The scope is the exact proposition in the question; do not substitute an adjacent doctrine or a memorised general essay.

Executable exam-length plan: about 250 words: thesis, five or six developed dimensions, a named comparison, the strongest objection/reply and a graded conclusion. Cut biography and repeated definitions before cutting evidence, qualification or verdict. **Model solution**

Introduction: Technocratic managerialism presents public decisions as questions for administrators and experts rather than conflicts among rival social purposes.

Core analysis: Galbraith's account helps explain why ideology may appear to decline: complex organisations transfer power to specialised managerial and technical elites, and policy is justified through efficiency, expertise and problem-solving. Expertise is indispensable for selecting workable means, but it cannot independently decide whose welfare counts, how risks should be distributed or which ends are legitimate. These are evaluative and political questions. The critics of the end-of-ideology thesis therefore argue that technical language may naturalise a particular distribution of power.

Further development: The strongest defence of technocracy is competence: specialised problems require knowledge that plebiscitary opinion cannot supply. The reply is that democratic control need not replace expertise; it must determine mandates, disclose assumptions and make experts accountable. Titmuss, Wright Mills, Macpherson and MacIntyre expose the residual issue: who defines efficiency and whose losses are treated as unavoidable. A sound settlement separates expert authority over means from public justification of ends, while recognising that even the means can embody distributional choices. Public reason-giving and institutional contestability must therefore accompany specialised administration.

Critical evaluation: Technocracy is neutral only within goals already chosen. When it conceals those prior choices or excludes public contestation, it performs an ideological function.

Conclusion: Technocratic expertise can improve means, but it becomes ideological when contested distributions of power are presented as merely technical necessities.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

How to improve this answer: Make the opening answer this exact demand - "Is technocratic managerialism ideologically neutral? Discuss with reference to the end-of-ideology debate." - rather than introducing the topic generally. Convert every major paragraph into claim -> named thinker, text or India-linked example -> what it proves -> limitation; preserve the model's decisive distinction and final qualification. For 20 marks, use the supplied compression plan and remove decorative biography or repeated definitions first.